FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-28-17001

Issue Title : Biocide and Engine Operational Issues

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2810-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
06/07/2017	06/07/2017	01/23/2017

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Description

Boeing has received reports from operators of engine operational issues due to improper biocide treatments of airplane fuel tanks.

More than the maximum concentration of biocide was added to the fuel tank or the biocide was added using a method that allowed high concentrations of biocide to collect in the bottom of the tank.

Ways incorrect biocide concentrations can be applied to an airplane and subsequently results in engine operational issues include:

* A metered injection cart which is out of calibration

* A malfunctioning and or broken biocide metering cart

* Miscalculation of pre-existing fuel uploads in the airplane prior to concentration of biocide being added with the cart

* Adding concentrated biocide directly to the fuel tank

Status

Article is advisory in nature.

Interim Action

N/A

Final Action

To address microbial contamination and to avoid engine operational and/or other issues Boeing recommends that operators reference the following AMM section and TASK to treat fuel tanks with biocide:

AMM Section 28-10-00

TASK 28-10-00-600-801: Treatment of Fuel Tanks Contaminated with Microbial Growth

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TASK 28-10-00-600-802: Biocide Treatment of Fuel Tanks – Metered Injection Cart

Care should be taken to ensure that the biocide metering cart is kept in proper functional order per the cart manufacturer's guidelines and serviced as required.

There are also known cases where biocide has been added directly to fuel tanks thru a wing tank access panel. Adding treatment manually this way is not an approved method of application. This method could result in undiluted volumes of biocide settling under fuel intakes. Do not add biocide to fuel tanks manually.

Operator Action

Operators must ensure that fuel meets or exceeds the requirements of the fuel specification listed in the AFM (specifically ASTM D1655 and the engine manufacturer's requirements). This includes procedures used to deliver and store the fuel before it is loaded into the airplane. Industry standard practices should be used to assure that the fuel is not contaminated with foreign material or that it degrades between the refinery and the airplane. Airlines should also be aware that there are a variety of approved jet fuel additives. Consult the jet fuel specifications and the engine manufacturer's documentation to determine which fuel additives are acceptable for use. See the reference service letter for more information regarding fuel specifications and additives.

Boeing recommends that operators follow the AMM fueling procedures when refueling the airplane. Each operator is responsible for complying with the local, state and national regulations regarding aircraft fuel servicing. It is possible that fire codes and standards make it necessary to use different or more restrictive procedures than those given in the AMM. Make sure the procedures used during the refuel operation give sufficient protection to persons and equipment.

Fuel System Maintenance – It is important that Fuel tank sumping is conducted periodically to help ensure that large quantities of water are not accumulating in the fuel tanks and that the fuel pumps and scavenge system are functioning as intended. Intervals should be determined by operators and based upon their operating environment, fuel management resources and in-service experience. Fuel sampling checks for microbial contamination task intervals should be based on the airplane operating environment, fuel source reliability, and operator in-service experience with incidents of fuel tank microbial growth and/or resulting issues such as fuel filter clogging, engine component malfunction and structural corrosion.

For fuel sampling / testing guidelines Boeing recommends referencing to the following AMM section and TASK:

AMM Section 28-10-00

TASK 28-10-00-200-801: Detection Test for Microbial Growth.

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	28-10-00		
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-28-071		

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability

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